

Acme Corp — Corporate Travel & Expense Policy

Effective: January 1, 2025 | Version 3.2 | Approved by: CFO & VP of Operations

Section 1 — Purpose & Scope

This policy governs all business-related travel and expense reimbursement for Acme Corp employees. It applies to domestic and international travel, client entertainment, conference attendance, and any out-of-pocket business expenses. All travel must be pre-approved before booking.

Employees are expected to exercise good judgment and select the most cost-effective options that meet business needs. Expenses that do not comply with this policy may be denied or require additional executive approval.

Section 2 — Approval Requirements

All travel and expenses require approval **before** they are incurred. The approval authority depends on the total estimated cost:

Expense Amount	Required Approver	Turnaround
Up to department auto-approve limit	No approval needed	Instant
Up to \$1,000	Direct Manager	1 business day
\$1,001 – \$5,000	Department Director	2 business days
\$5,001 – \$15,000	VP of Finance	3 business days
Over \$15,000	CFO	5 business days

Note: Verbal or informal approvals (e.g., Slack messages, hallway conversations) are **not** valid substitutes for formal approval through the system. Claims of prior verbal approval will be rejected.

Section 3 — Air Travel

3.1 Domestic Flights

- Economy class is required for all flights under 4 hours.
- Premium economy may be approved for flights over 4 hours with manager approval.
- Business class requires Director-level approval regardless of flight duration.
- Flights must be booked at least 14 days in advance when possible to secure lower fares.

3.2 International Flights

- Economy class for flights under 6 hours; premium economy for 6–10 hours.
- Business class may be approved for flights over 10 hours with VP-level approval.
- All international travel requires VP-level approval **regardless of amount**.
- International itineraries must be submitted at least 14 days in advance.

Section 4 — Lodging

Employees should select reasonably priced hotels convenient to the business destination.

- Domestic hotel cap: **\$200 per night** (standard markets).
- High-cost city surcharge: **\$300 per night** for NYC, SF, LA, DC, Boston, Seattle.
- International hotel cap: **\$250 per night**, or the GSA/State Department rate for the destination country, whichever is higher.
- Extended stays (5+ nights): employees must seek a negotiated corporate rate or use the company's preferred hotel program.

Section 5 — Meals & Per Diem

Meal expenses are reimbursed up to the following daily limits per person:

Meal Type	Domestic	International
Breakfast	\$15	\$20
Lunch	\$20	\$30
Dinner	\$40	\$50
Daily Total	\$75	\$100

Alcohol is **not** reimbursable unless part of a pre-approved client entertainment event. Tips up to 20% may be included in the meal total.

Section 6 — Ground Transportation

- Rental cars: economy or compact class. Upgrade requires manager approval.
- Rideshare (Uber, Lyft): standard/economy tier for trips under 20 miles.
- Personal vehicle mileage: reimbursed at the current IRS rate (\$0.67/mile for 2025).
- Parking and tolls are reimbursable with receipts.

Section 7 — Receipts & Documentation

Itemized receipts are **required** for all individual expenses over **\$25**. Credit card statements alone are not acceptable. Expenses submitted without proper receipts will be denied.

All expense reports must be submitted within **30 days** of the trip end date. Late submissions may be denied at the discretion of Finance.

Section 8 — Non-Reimbursable Expenses

The following are never reimbursable:

- Personal entertainment (movies, sightseeing, spa services)
- Traffic fines, parking tickets, or moving violations
- Travel insurance (company already provides coverage)

- Airline club memberships or lounge access (unless pre-approved)
- Upgrades beyond policy limits without prior written approval
- Gifts to clients or partners exceeding \$50 without Director approval
- Expenses for family members or non-employees traveling with the employee

Section 9 — Conferences & Training

- Registration fees require approval per the standard approval matrix above.
- Early-bird registration is strongly encouraged to reduce costs.
- Travel to conferences follows all rules in Sections 3–7.
- The employee's manager must confirm the event is relevant to the employee's role.

Section 10 — Policy Violations

Violations of this policy may result in:

- Denial of the expense claim
- Requirement to repay reimbursed amounts
- Disciplinary action up to and including termination for repeated or fraudulent violations

Attempts to circumvent this policy — including submitting fabricated receipts, splitting expenses to stay under approval thresholds, or claiming informal/verbal pre-approval — will be treated as policy violations and referred to HR.

Questions about this policy should be directed to the Finance Department at travel-policy@acmecorp.com.